

with India's Union MoS for Science & Technology, Dr Jitendra Singh, to discuss the bilateral collaboration in technology. The Indo-US Science and Technology Forum (IUSSTF) and the Secretariat for USISTEF will facilitate the call for proposals. Initiatives can be proposed by startups, academic institutions, governments, and commercial enterprises, as long as they focus on applied R&D, have a business plan, proof of commercial concept, and sustainable commercial potential.

Government imposes penalties on OEMs under FAME-II

The Ministry of Heavy Industries received complaints against 17 original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) under the FAME India Scheme Phase-II in the past 18 months. The manufacturers were investigated for complaints about PMP compliance and ex-factory price breach. Examination of reports from testing agencies revealed that six OEMs were fully PMP compliant, while seven were violating PMP norms. Penalties were imposed on non-compliant OEMs, including holding incentive payments and refunds for excess amounts. Four OEMs agreed to refund excess amounts to customers/purchasers of electric vehicles (EVs) due to ex-factory price breaches.

BEL partners with Gabriel Power, Energy, and CoRover for AI-based energy solutions

Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) has formed partnerships with Gabriel Power and Energy Pvt Ltd and CoRover Pvt Ltd to advance energy solutions and AI-driven conversational platforms. BEL's partnership with Gabriel Power and Energy Pvt Ltd intends to introduce and manufacture various energy products in India, including EV chargers, smart meters, green hydrogen generation, hydrogen gensets, and solar steam solutions for the government and private sectors. CoRover Pvt Ltd and BEL have signed a two-year MoU to

indigenously develop and deploy CoRover's BharatGPT platforms, focusing on AI-based conversational solutions. BEL's latest partnerships are set to enhance energy solutions and AI-driven platforms, contributing to India's technological and manufacturing advancement.

Tata Group to invest GBP 4 billion in UK gigafactory

Tata Group plans to invest GBP 4 billion in establishing a battery gigafactory in the UK. Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) and Tata Motors will be the anchor customers, with supplies starting from 2026. Tata Sons, the parent company of Tata Group, plans to build a 40GW battery cell gigafactory. This will be one of Europe's largest battery cell manufacturing facilities. The gigafactory's primary objective is to provide electric mobility and renewable energy storage solutions for the UK and European customers.

Applied Materials works to bring foreign suppliers to India

Applied Materials aims to encourage its suppliers from Europe, Japan, and other regions to establish operations in India. The company said it attracted 25 suppliers to Semicon India 2023. This move is part of Applied Materials' strategy to enhance the local supply chain and support its expansion in the Indian market. The company plans to invest \$400 million in a new engineering centre in Bengaluru, India, focusing on chipmaking tool technology development. While Applied Materials does not manufacture in India, local suppliers' proximity to Applied Materials'

operations is crucial for accelerating product learning cycles, introducing a wider range of products more quickly, and supporting high-volume manufacturing solutions.

EV charging at public stations subject to 18% GST

Charging electric vehicle batteries at public charging stations is subject to an 18% GST, according to the Karnataka Authority for Advance Ruling (AAR). The AAR determined that the activity of charging an EV constitutes a supply of service rather than a supply of electricity or movable property. The ruling came about when a power distribution company sought to establish public charging stations for EVs and proposed an electric vehicle charging fee comprising energy and service charges. The Ministry of Power's clarification was referenced, stating that EV charging within station premises does not involve selling electricity to individuals.

Tata Power launches RFID cards for EV charging

Tata Power has launched RFID-enabled cards to enhance the convenience and accessibility of its EV charging infrastructure, which includes over 40,000 home chargers, 4,000+ public and semi-public charging points, and 250 bus-charging points across India. The RFID card aims to simplify the EV charging process and promote the adoption of electric vehicles by providing tap, charge, and go functionality. The card's built-in chip ensures efficient, secure, and seamless initiation of charging sessions and payments, boosting user confidence.

SNIPPETS



- Jammu smart city receives prototype electric bus model; to commence trial run soon
- BEST expands electric double-decker bus fleet to 24
- Banks may ease lending norms for solar units
- Landscape Capital acquires stake in Navitas Semiconductor for \$729,000
- Amara Raja Batteries to enter two-wheeler market to power growth
- Uno Minda Eyes ₹16 billion revenue from EV systems by FY26
- U-blox, ORBCOMM partner to merge terrestrial and satellite IoT communications solutions
- Infineon, startup Jiva Materials partner for recyclable PCBs